



TERROR

terrorist agencies from the neighbourhood, the nation scrabbles for ways to counter the threat.

been neutralised, 488 persons arrested and 86 terrorists, including 57 Pakistani nationals, were killed. When security agencies unearthed information about their training, future plans, names of associates, and most importantly, Pakistan's direct involvement, they understood that the new face of terror was disjointed and anonymous. The entire operation, controlled from across the border through a series of couriers, was broken up into a series of steps with responsibilities handed over to different people (*see graphic*). Unlike in a terror cell, none of the conspirators

terrorists could be behind the attack, Islamabad has condemned it and termed the statement a "conjecture".

HUJI, the Bangladesh-based organisation that first shot into prominence with the blasts in the Shramjeevi Express and in Varanasi, works in collaboration with usual suspects like Lashkar-e-Toiba (LeT) and Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM). Confessions by a dozen HUJI terrorists over the past two years point to a new set of ISI camps being run in remote Balochistan since

FLAT-FOOTED: The state Government is reeling under shock



Bangladeshis, to deny its direct involvement. HUJI is believed to be behind at least four of the 11 attacks in India in the past two years, which took a toll of over 500. Confessions by Jalaluddin Mullah a.k.a. Babu Bhai, a HUJI activist captured by Uttar Pradesh's Special Task Force in May, point to HUJI's involvement in the Delhi blasts of October 2005, which killed 62.

Earlier, ISI-sponsored terror organisations worked on the principle of cells or modules, which were sneaked into a city, put up in rented accommodation and provided explosives to carry out their missions. In the past five years, 159 ISI-backed terrorist modules have

knew the identity of the other any more, so an operator's arrest didn't result in the busting of the entire module. The operations could be planned anywhere and the resources acquired throughout the hinterland. In the Mecca Masjid incident, the SIM card found in one of the unexploded bombs was procured in Jharkhand using a fake identity card. "In the post-9/11 world where there is no tolerance for terrorism, it has become important for Pakistan to make itself less identifiable as the sponsor of terrorism," explains security analyst Ajai Sahni. While Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy has said Pakistani

2003, where Indians and Bangladeshis are trained for a month in groups of four-five in the art of assembling improvised explosives from locally available materials like ammonium nitrate. Intelligence agencies say Pakistani army personnel and not religious groups run these camps, where recruits are offered Coke, carrom and television and praying five times a day is not mandatory. Over 50 operatives have been trained in such camps so far.

Frequent arrests of HUJI operators point to its growing profile and audacity in crossing the porous India-Bangladesh border. The first evidence of HUJI being used as ISI's cat's paw in

"Organisations in Bangladesh and Pakistan might be involved."

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